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1 ROLE OF TECHNOLOGY IN MAINTAINING LAW AND ORDER

With criminals becoming tech-savvy, police and the courts also need to know the latest tools and make use of the latest technologies like cyber policing, artificial intelligence, data analytics, blockchain and cloud computing



(Credit: www.tagesspiegel.de)

Reducing crime rates and delivering speedy justice to the needy is a challenging task globally. It requires smart policing and effectively dealing with roadblocks in legal proceedings. Although the adoption is slower when compared to other sectors like finance and insurance due to the ethics constraints involved, science and technology are being increasingly leveraged by enterprises to accomplish this mission. This is proved by the success of Global Legal Hackathon 2019 that was organised to develop technical solutions for the industry, in which participation of

over 6,000 people across 46 cities in 24 countries was seen.

As criminals become more tech-savvy, police personnel need to know the latest tools and scientific methods to keep up with them. Automating manual activities that are rule-based and repetitive through robotic process automation can save time and manpower. Investigating and understanding the intricacies of even the most pressing cases has become easier with the aid of CCTV footage, which also serves as valuable evidence in the court, especially in the absence of witnesses. Digitisation of cases ensures

full electronic access to past history of all records. Analysing the data from first-hand evidence at the site in real time provides a good overview of cases from the beginning.

Telangana Police is among those taking diverse initiatives since past few years to maintain law and order in the state. For instance, mobile apps like TSCOP, ePetty case, Cop Connect, Facial Recognition System, and e-Challan system launched by the department have played a huge role in data sharing and structuring the system. Another such attempt comes from IIIT Delhi, where a research centre has been built to assist the capital's police for such purposes as criminals' identification, cyber policing, traffic management, and combating crimes by using artificial intelligence (AI), biometrics, image processing, Big Data, social media analysis and network forensics.

Technologies like AI, analytics, blockchain, and cloud computing are making their way into the courtrooms, too. AI-powered tools can be used by lawyers for most daily tasks, from reviewing documents and performing legal research rapidly to predicting various outcomes of a case. Businesses can utilise AI to review contracts for partnerships without any bias, and perform background checks before hiring new employees to avoid getting into legal troubles later.

Several companies in countries like the US, Singapore, the UK, Canada and Australia are using technologies